CHAPTER 22 · REFERENCE DEPTH

Voice Weather Broadcasts

While data-link (D-ATIS/D-VOLMET) is now standard in modern cockpits, the exam focuses on the traditional voice broadcasts — VOLMET and ATIS — that continuously transmit met conditions on loop over VHF or HF. This chapter covers their structure, differences, and how they keep pilots updated without cluttering the control frequencies.

SYLLABUS MAP

Part III (x) VOLMET & ATIS broadcasts

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◎ Learning objectives — by the end of this chapter you will be able to...

- Define ATIS and VOLMET.
- Explain the sequence and contents of an ATIS broadcast.
- Explain the sequence and contents of a VOLMET broadcast.
- Understand how to use and acknowledge these broadcasts.

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22.1 ATIS — the local picture
22.2 VOLMET — the regional picture
22.3 The broadcast sequence
22.4 Using the information
☆ Numbers to memorise
? Question bank



Continuous voice broadcasts allow pilots to copy down weather and aerodrome information before contacting ATC, drastically reducing congestion on the main control frequencies.

22.1 ATIS — the local picture

DEFINITION — AUTOMATIC TERMINAL INFORMATION SERVICE

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ATIS is the continuous broadcast of recorded non-control information in selected high-activity terminal areas. It contains **both meteorological and operational information** (runway in use, approach type, transition level) for a **single aerodrome**. It is updated when conditions change significantly, and each update is given an **alphabetical designator** (Alpha, Bravo, Charlie...).

MNEMONIC — THE PURPOSE

The purpose of ATIS is **to relieve frequency congestion**. Because the pilot listens to the ATIS on a separate frequency before calling approach, the controller does not have to read the weather and runway details to every arriving aircraft.

22.2 VOLMET — the regional picture

DEFINITION — VOLMET

VOLMET (meteorological information for aircraft in flight) is a continuous or scheduled voice broadcast of meteorological information for **several aerodromes in a region**. It contains **only met information** (METARs, TRENDs, and sometimes TAFs or SIGMETs) — no operational details like runway-in-use. It allows an aircraft in the cruise to check the weather at its destination and alternates well in advance.

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Feature	ATIS	VOLMET
Scope	One specific aerodrome (terminal area)	Several aerodromes in a region
Contents	Weather **AND** operational info (runway, approaches, NOTAMs)	**ONLY** weather (METAR, TREND, TAF, SIGMET)
Updates	Designated by a letter (Information Alpha)	Usually updated every half hour (no letter)

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22.3 The broadcast sequence

THE STANDARD ORDER

Both ATIS and VOLMET follow the standard meteorological sequence (the same order as a METAR): **identification · time · surface wind · visibility/RVR · weather · cloud · temperature/dew point · QNH · trend**.

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TRANSCRIPT — TYPICAL ATIS

ATIS Delhi International Airport, information Charlie, zero eight three zero zulu. Expect ILS approach runway two seven, runway two seven and two eight in use. Wind two four zero degrees, one zero knots. Visibility three thousand metres. Haze. Cloud

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few three thousand feet. Temperature three two, dew point two zero. QNH one zero zero nine. Acknowledge receipt of information Charlie on initial contact.

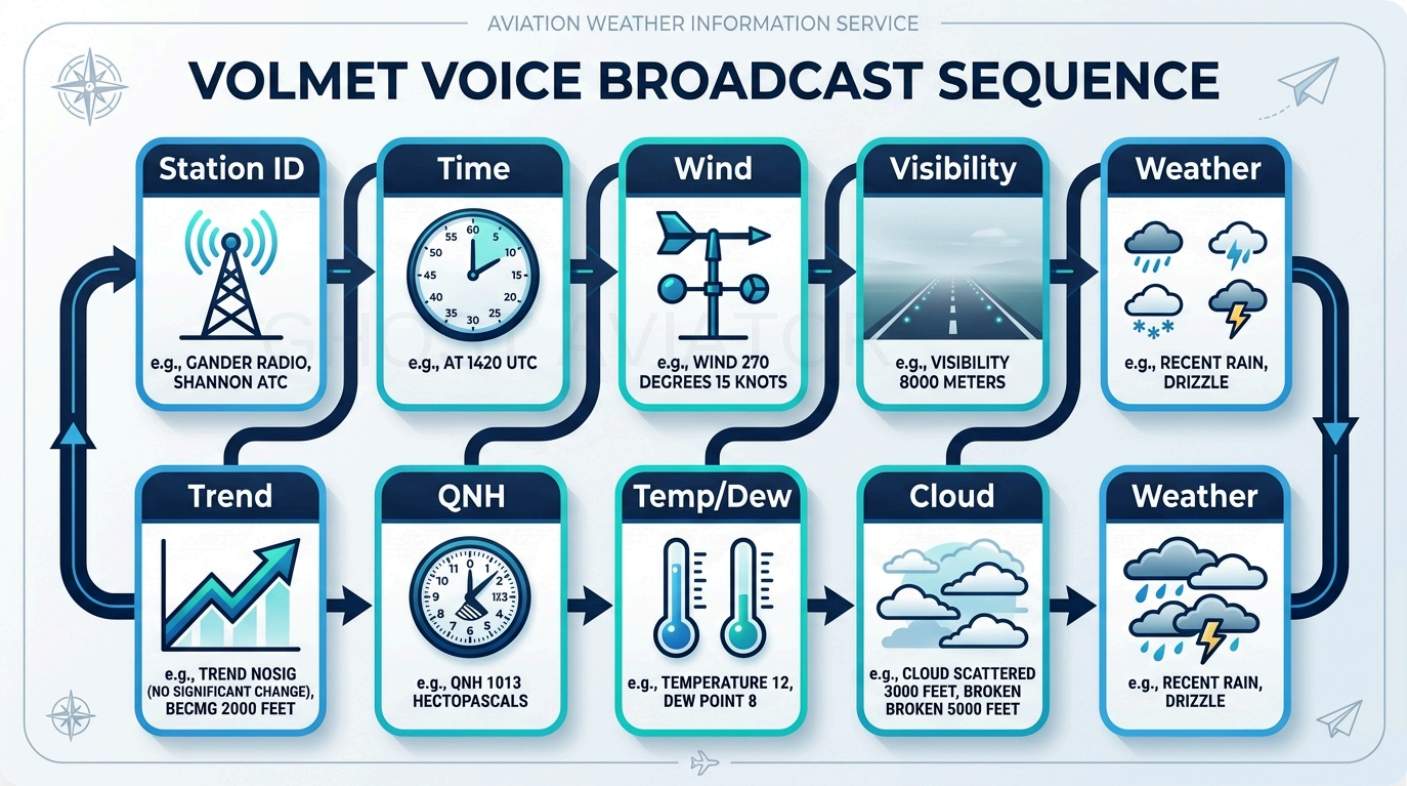


Figure 22.1 — The Sequence: The broadcast strictly follows the METAR order, allowing pilots to rapidly copy the data into standard forms on their kneeboards.

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22.4 Using the information

✓ ACKNOWLEDGING ATIS

When making initial contact with Approach or Ground, the pilot states they have the ATIS by giving the **letter** and the **QNH** (to prove it is the correct current version). Example: "**Delhi Approach, Ghostair ABC, descending flight level one five zero,**

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information Charlie, QNH one zero zero nine." The controller then does not need to read the weather to them.

☆ Numbers to memorise

Essential Facts for Chapter 22	
Fact	**Value**
ATIS	Automatic Terminal Information Service
ATIS covers	One aerodrome; met AND operational info (runways/approaches)
ATIS identifier	Alphabetical letter (Alpha, Bravo, etc.)
VOLMET covers	Several aerodromes; ONLY met info (no runways)
Sequence	ID · time · wind · vis · weather · cloud · temp/dew · QNH · trend
Pilot action (ATIS)	State information letter and QNH on initial contact with ATC

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Question bank

Part A — MCQs (click an option to check)

1. What does ATIS stand for?

Aviation Terminal Information System

Automatic Terminal Information Service

Aerodrome Traffic Information Service

Air Traffic Instruction Service

Answer: Automatic Terminal Information Service.

ATIS is the Automatic Terminal Information Service.

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2. An ATIS broadcast contains:

Only meteorological information for several aerodromes

Meteorological and operational information for a single aerodrome

Control clearances

Radar vectors

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Answer: Meteorological and operational information for a single aerodrome.

ATIS covers one aerodrome and includes operational data like runway-in-use.

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3. The primary purpose of ATIS is to:

Provide radar separation

Relieve frequency congestion on the ATC channels

Clear aircraft to land

Broadcast distress messages

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Answer: Relieve frequency congestion on the ATC channels.

By putting routine info on a separate broadcast, the main frequency is kept clear.

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4. Successive ATIS broadcasts are identified by:

A number

An alphabetical letter (e.g. Information Alpha)

The frequency

A squawk code

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Answer: An alphabetical letter (e.g. Information Alpha).

Each new ATIS update gets the next letter in the alphabet.

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5. VOLMET contains:

Runway in use and approach types

Only meteorological information for several aerodromes in a region

Only information for a single aerodrome

Control clearances

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Answer: Only meteorological information for several aerodromes in a region.

VOLMET provides only weather, for multiple stations.

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6. On initial contact with ATC, a pilot proves receipt of the ATIS by stating:

"Weather copied"

The information letter and the QNH

The surface wind

"Roger ATIS"

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Answer: The information letter and the QNH.

"Information Charlie, QNH 1009" confirms you have the latest and correct version.

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7. The standard sequence of elements in an ATIS/VOLMET is:

Randomised to keep pilots alert

Wind, visibility, weather, cloud, temp/dew, QNH

QNH, wind, cloud, visibility, temp

Temp, wind, QNH, cloud, visibility

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Answer: Wind, visibility, weather, cloud, temp/dew, QNH.

It follows the standard METAR sequence.

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8. If an aircraft hears the ATIS, does the controller need to read the weather to them?

Yes, always

No, not unless there is a significant change

Only the wind

Only the QNH

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Answer: No, not unless there is a significant change.

That is the whole point of ATIS — to save the controller passing it.

Part B — Oral / viva (tap to reveal model answers)

▼ ? **What is ATIS and what is its purpose?**

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Model Answer:
Automatic Terminal Information Service is the continuous broadcast of recorded meteorological and operational information for a single aerodrome. Its purpose is to relieve frequency congestion on the main ATC channels.

▼ ? **How does VOLMET differ from ATIS?**

Model Answer:
VOLMET provides only meteorological information (no operational info like runway-in-use)

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and covers several aerodromes in a region, whereas ATIS covers a single aerodrome and includes operational data.

▼ ? What is the standard sequence of weather elements in a broadcast?

Model Answer:

Surface wind, visibility (or RVR), present weather, cloud, temperature and dew point, QNH, and trend.

▼ ? How should a pilot acknowledge receipt of the ATIS?

Model Answer:

On initial contact with ATC, the pilot states the ATIS information letter and the QNH — e.g. "Information Bravo, QNH 1012."

⚡ 60-SECOND REVISION CARD

ATIS = 1 aerodrome; met + operational info (runway); identified by a letter; relieves frequency congestion.
VOLMET = regional (multiple aerodromes); ONLY met info.
Sequence: wind · vis · weather · cloud · temp/dew · QNH.
Acknowledge ATIS by stating the letter and QNH on initial contact.

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